

Morning Briefing

Wednesday 23 September 2026 | Generated 06:18 London time (BST) | Data collected via live web search, approx. 05:30–06:20 London time | **Several figures below could not be cross-confirmed across sources — flagged inline. Verify before trading.**

1. Important News

Nasdaq hits fresh record on AI/chip rally. Intel, Meta and AMD each jumped over 9% on AI-commercialization enthusiasm; Nasdaq 100 posted its first record since June. Source: Bloomberg, CNBC (22 Sep). Why it matters: sets a risk-on tone for the European open, tech-heavy indices likely to open bid.

Oil slides on Iran de-escalation signals. WTI extended its recent decline amid reports Saudi Arabia is routing additional supply through the Strait of Hormuz as diplomatic efforts with Iran progress. Source: Bloomberg (22 Sep). Why it matters: eases inflation pressure, supportive for bond yields and equities, negative for energy names.

ECB hiked to 2.5% on 10 September; Fed still hawkish. ECB flagged risk of higher inflation and weaker growth; Fed's Collins cited renewed Iran conflict as a reason for last week's hike and pencilled in one more hike this year. Source: CNBC (10 Sep, 22 Sep). Why it matters: both central banks signal further tightening risk despite growth concerns.

Sterling near two-month low. GBP/USD fell to ~1.336 on weaker-than-expected UK public finances and firmer oil. Source: FXStreet (22 Sep). Why it matters: adds pressure into today's UK data and FTSE-listed importers/exporters.

Tokyo shut for Japan's first 5-day "Silver Week" in over a decade. Nikkei 225 has not traded since Friday 18 Sept and reopens Thursday 24 Sept. Source: BBN Times. Why it matters: thin regional liquidity, no fresh Tokyo signal for today's Asia read-through.

2. European Futures (Pre-Open)

INDEX	FUTURES MOVE	EXPECTED DIRECTION
Euro Stoxx 50	+0.32%	Higher
DAX	+0.27%	Higher
CAC 40	+0.24%	Higher
FTSE 100	+0.20%	Higher
S&P 500 futures	n/a	Not reliably sourced — Wall St momentum (record Nasdaq close) is positive context
Nasdaq futures	n/a	Not reliably sourced — Wall St momentum (record Nasdaq close) is positive context

Source: First Squawk (X), ~06:00–07:00 London. Note: thin volume flagged in the original post.

3. Yesterday's Closes — European Indices

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
Euro Stoxx 50	6,305.30	-0.20%
DAX	25,502.39	-0.28%
CAC 40	8,154.91	+0.20%
FTSE 100	10,737.36	-0.02%

Source: Trading Economics, Yahoo Finance, ad-hoc-news.de. Session: Tuesday 22 September 2026.

4. US Markets — Yesterday's Session (22 Sep)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
S&P 500	7,764.64	~flat (-0.0%)
Dow Jones	51,864	-0.36% (-185 pts)
Nasdaq	27,244 (record)	+0.5%

Tone: tech-led rally, broad index flat-to-lower. Nasdaq 100 hit its first record since June. Communication Services led sectors (+3.88%), Technology +2.89%. Intel, Meta Platforms and AMD each gained over 9% on AI-commercialization evidence.

Laggards: banks sold off on "AI disintermediation" fears, capping the Dow and offsetting the tech advance.

Key takeaway: AI/chip enthusiasm plus falling oil and softer yields drove risk-on positioning in growth/tech; financials underperformed on structural AI-disruption concerns.

Source: Bloomberg, CNBC, Schwab, CappNotes (22 Sep).

5. Asian Markets — Overnight Session

INDEX	LEVEL	CHANGE
Nikkei 225	Market closed (Silver Week holiday)	Last close Fri 18 Sep: 65,018.95 (+1.38%). Reopens Thu 24 Sep.
Hang Seng	n/a	Source data was internally inconsistent with historical index range — not reported to avoid publishing an unreliable figure
Shanghai Composite	~3,952.1 (single source, low confidence)	Little changed
Kospi	n/a	Not reliably sourced

Tone and drivers: regional liquidity thin with Tokyo shut for a rare 5-day holiday. Limited reliable overnight data; qualitative read is broadly steady-to-mixed following Wall Street's tech-led gains. Treat this section with more caution than usual — verify directly before using.

Source: Trading Economics, 24/7 Wall St, BBN Times.

6. Commodities

COMMODITY	LEVEL	CHANGE
Brent	~\$98.4/bbl (single source)	n/a
WTI	n/a — conflicting sources (\$89.89–\$95.59 range quoted)	Declining (directionally consistent across sources)
Gold	\$4,307.63/oz (one source quoted \$4,382.50 for Dec futures — range, not confirmed)	-0.81%
Natural gas	n/a	Not sourced
Copper	\$6.75/lb	+0.92%

Notable move: oil is the standout, falling on reports of easing Iran tensions and rerouted Saudi supply via the Strait of Hormuz — a tailwind for the broader risk rally and a driver behind softer bond yields. Exact print is unreliable this morning; confirm level before using in analysis.

Source: Trading Economics, Yahoo Finance, Bloomberg (22 Sep).

7. Rates & FX

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE
US 10Y Treasury	4.97%	+0.01pp
German 10Y Bund	3.44%	-0.01pp
EUR/USD	1.1455	n/a
GBP/USD	1.3357	-0.07%, near 2-month low
DX	100.42	Unchanged, near 3-month high

Source: Trading Economics, FXStreet (22 Sep).

8. DCM — Primary Bond Market

Yesterday's Issuances

n/a — no specific EUR IG/HY/SSA/financials deal terms (issuer, size, maturity, coupon/spread, IPT-to-pricing) could be reliably sourced for 22 September. GlobalCapital and IFR primary-market deal sheets were not accessible via search for this date.

Pipeline / Expected Today

n/a — no mandated or expected deal list could be reliably sourced for today or this week.

Key Spreads

SPREAD	LEVEL	MOVE
iTraxx Main	<i>n/a</i>	<i>Not sourced</i>
iTraxx Crossover	<i>n/a</i>	<i>Not sourced</i>
CDX IG	<i>n/a</i>	<i>Not sourced</i>
Avg EUR corporate IG spread	<i>n/a</i>	<i>Not sourced</i>
OAT–Bund sovereign spread	102.0 bps	n/a direction

Commentary

Primary market window looks open but selective: GlobalCapital reports euro IG corporate and covered bond new-issue premiums (NIPs) climbing as order books thin, suggesting issuers are paying slightly more concession even as issuance activity stays elevated into month-end. No sector or deal-level detail could be confirmed for industrials, transport, energy or financials specifically today — treat this section as directional only, not a live market check.

Source: GlobalCapital ("Euro IG corporate bond NIPs climb as books thin"; "Euro covered bond issuers find window for tight deals with slim NIPs"), Ideal-Investisseur.fr (OAT/Bund spread, 22 Sep).

9. Economic Calendar — Today

n/a — Trading Economics indicates roughly 49 scheduled events today (23 Sep) across markets, but a specific time-stamped breakdown for Eurozone/UK/US releases could not be reliably retrieved. Most recent confirmed macro print: Eurozone flash composite PMI rose to 52.1 in August (a nine-month high), not a today release. Recommend checking Trading Economics or Econoday directly before the open.

10. Corporate Events & Earnings

US: Cintas (CTAS), Paychex (PAYX), General Mills (GIS) report today.

Europe: one UK sportswear retailer is scheduled to report at 06:00 GMT today; the specific name could not be confirmed from available sources — flagged rather than guessed. Roughly a dozen STOXX Europe 600 constituents are reporting in the 22–24 September window, which may lift index-level volatility.

Source: Earnings Whispers, Finimize (23 Sep calendar).

11. Stocks to Watch

APA Corporation — analyst downgrade to Hold. Probable direction: **lower**.

HF Sinclair — recent analyst downgrade. Probable direction: **lower**.

Wolford AG — H1 2026 results showed improved EBIT despite a slight revenue decline. Probable direction: **higher**.

Aviation, Shipping, Metals & Mining, Aerospace & Defense and banking names specifically were not reliably identified for today's session — search results did not surface sector-specific movers for 23 September. Recommend checking broker pre-market notes directly for this skew.

Source: general pre-market movers coverage (dates approximate, not all confirmed for 23 Sep specifically — treat with caution).

12. Macro / Corporate / Political Highlights

Macro

ECB hiked to 2.5% on 10 September, flagging risk of higher inflation alongside weaker growth.

Fed's Collins cited the renewed Iran conflict as a reason for last week's hike; pencils in one more hike this year, holds expected in 2027.

ECB's Lane: eurozone growth should stay steady if the energy shock doesn't intensify, but a second energy-price wave will push inflation higher before it eases toward target from mid-2027.

Corporate

AI commercialization theme (including Meta's new "Muse" agent) driving the chip/tech rally — Intel, Meta, AMD each +9%+ on 22 Sept.

Bank stocks broadly under pressure on "AI disintermediation" concerns, a theme to watch at the European open.

Euro primary bond market: new-issue premiums rising as order books thin, per GlobalCapital.

Political / Geopolitical

Iran: signs of de-escalation — Trump reportedly open to talks with President Pezeshkian; envoy Mike Waltz says the US remains open to Iran returning to the table in good faith.

Ukraine: Naftogaz reports a Russian strike caused critical, effectively irreparable damage to energy infrastructure — a factor for European energy security into winter.

UN General Assembly week in New York — bilateral diplomacy touching the Persian Gulf, Red Sea and Black Sea conflicts.

Source: CNBC, Bloomberg, Newsquawk, ADMISI Day Ahead (Sep 2026).

13. Key Themes — Top 5 by Horizon

Today's Top 5

AI/chip rally momentum. Can Wall Street's record Nasdaq close carry through to European tech names at the open.

Oil direction. Further declines on Iran diplomacy would extend the equity/rates tailwind; a reversal would flip the narrative.

Sterling weakness. GBP near a two-month low into today's UK data — downside risk if public finance concerns persist.

Central bank speak. Fed and ECB officials framing the rate path around UNGA sidelines — watch for fresh hawkish/dovish signals.

Bank sector sentiment. AI-disintermediation selloff in US banks — watch whether European financials open under similar pressure.

This Week's Top 5

Japan reopening. Nikkei resumes trading Thursday after a rare 5-day Silver Week closure — catch-up risk.

STOXX 600 earnings cluster. A dozen-plus constituents reporting 22–24 September may lift index volatility.

UNGA diplomacy. Iran, Ukraine, Red Sea and Black Sea developments in focus all week.

US payrolls (Friday). Referenced as this week's key US data point for the Fed's path — exact forecast not sourced, check nearer the time.

Euro primary supply. Test of investor appetite as NIPs widen into month-end issuance.

This Month's Top 5

Fed rate path. One more 2026 hike flagged by Collins, holds pencilled for 2027.

ECB guidance. Post-hike commentary on how a second energy-price wave feeds into the 2027 inflation path.

Iran negotiation trajectory. Ceasefire/talks prospects versus renewed escalation risk ahead of the US midterms.

Ukraine energy strikes. Implications for European energy security and prices heading into winter.

Quarter-end bond supply. Issuers likely to front-load EUR IG/HY deals before Q4 windows narrow.

14. Key Trends to Watch

1 Day

European open follow-through on the Wall Street AI rally; oil price direction; UK data and sterling.

1 Week

Japan's reopening after Silver Week; US payrolls Friday; the STOXX 600 earnings cluster; continued UNGA diplomacy.

1 Month

Fed and ECB rate paths; Iran negotiation outcome; Ukraine energy infrastructure risk into winter; quarter-end EUR bond supply.

Sources: Bloomberg, CNBC, Reuters/FXStreet, Trading Economics, Yahoo Finance, GlobalCapital, Investing.com, BBN Times, 24/7 Wall St, Newsquawk, ADMISI, Ideal-Investisseur.fr, Earnings Whispers, Finimize.

Data collected automatically. Verify before making any decision. A larger-than-usual share of data points in this edition are marked n/a or flagged as low-confidence — live search coverage for several instruments (Asian index levels, oil, DCM deal specifics, credit spreads, detailed economic calendar) was inconsistent this morning. Treat flagged figures as directional, not tradable.